

El Paso Hosting Jewish Cage Tilt

El Paso is hosting the 1976 Western Area Basketball Championships of the Jewish Welfare Board Friday through Sunday at the Jewish Community Center, 405 Mardi Gras.

This is an official tournament with the winner advancing to the national finals to be held in mid-April in Washington, D.C. The age group involved is 14-18.

The three-day competition in El Paso will be between the Jewish community centers of El Paso, Phoenix, Ft. Worth, Dallas, San Diego and Los Angeles. This year's basketball championships are also known as the "Bicentennial Hoopla."

Action starts at 12:30 p.m. Friday with a first-round game pitting Los Angeles against

Dallas. At 2 p.m., San Diego goes against Ft. Worth and El Paso squares off against Phoenix at 3:30 p.m.

Games resume at 7 p.m. Saturday with quarterfinals slated to begin at 9:30 a.m. Sunday. The championship game will be played at 5:30 p.m. Sunday.

The tournament will end with an award's banquet Sunday night. Featured speaker is Andy Cohen, baseball coach at the University of Texas at El Paso.

El Paso's team, the J.C.C. Stars, goes into the tournament with a 19-2 record, averaging 53.2 points a game while holding opponents to 36.2 points a game.